

SEPTEMBER 16-30, 1979

sions. Late planning and procurement of where-withal has made our police and armed forces vulnerable to the new techniques used by the terrorist masterminds. The nation has paid a heavy price when it had an inert home minister for four long years. The prime minister should give as much priority to national security as he does to economic growth.
Y.G. CHOUKSEY, Pune

It seems that we are committing a sort of harakiri by refusing to learn lessons from terrorist attacks. There seems to be total administrative failure. The refusal of the UPA Government to grant permission to the Gujarat government to enact much-needed and stringent anti-terror laws shows the lack of political will. Now it is up to the intelligentsia across the nation to generate strong public opinion, with the help of the media, against the soft-pedalling by the government on the issue of national security.

A.K. SHARMA,
Chandigarh

Statue Moves

I understand Lucknow is now dotted with giant statues of Mayawati and Kanshi Ram ("Back to the Stone Age", July 13). What public purpose these statues serve is beyond comprehension, that too in a state where millions

live below the poverty line. Instead of improving their condition, Mayawati is thrusting her own memory on the public psyche.

J. SESHAGIRI, Mysore

Rescue Mission

Air India and Indian Airlines making huge losses is hardly surprising ("Mayday! Mayday!", July 13). The Government's apathy and mismanagement has created the mess. In this competitive industry, circumspection and disci-

would hope that he demonstrates the transparency that he would expect from government ministries ("Question of Identity", July 13). He could, in fact, take a leaf out of Shashi Tharoor's notebook ("Twittering Minister", July 13) by penning his observations in the form of an online blog.
GAURAV SOBTI,

via www.indiatoday.in

Holding Fort

It is a bit premature to

QAMAR SIBTAIN



Our evaluation system should be based on industry adaptation rather than having students reproduce textbook matter in examinations.

K. CHIDANAND KUMAR, Bangalore

pline is needed for any airline to survive. Employees should voluntarily ask for reduction in their undue perks to help the airline reduce its losses.
V.K. TANGRI, Dehradun

Card Game

With Nandan Nilekani heading the UIDAI, one

write the epitaph of the CPI(M) ("Hammered and Stricken", July 6). One must not forget that it is the only political party in the democratic world which has enjoyed the support of the people of a state in India for 33 years.

B. BAGCHI,

via www.indiatoday.in

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Cricket's Superstar

Two days after his return from a gruelling tour of England, and a day before he was flying to Madras to do battle with the Australians, Sunil Gavaskar insisted on playing a Kanga League cricket match for his old club—Dadar Union. "I must play at least one match for my local team," he said. It is precisely this attitude that has triggered off the tonnes of fan mail that pour in through his letter-box each day. Enough to make even Amitabh Bachchan blush with embarrassment. Gavaskar estimates that there are about 400 letters currently lying unopened—"I just don't have the physical ability to cope with all those letters," he complains good-naturedly. Unlike other stars of his stature, Gavaskar is anything but a social animal. His idea of a pleasant evening is staying at home and horsing around with son Rohan, which involves playing cricket. Rohan fancies himself a pace bowler and only answers when you call him "Thomson". **by Dillip Bobb with Shirish Nadkarni**



GAVASKAR
WITH SON
ROHAN